



Apprentice Program Guidelines

Apprentices are a huge asset to ananda hair studio. First and foremost, you are future stylists. Our goal is to help you, to teach you, to build your confidence, and to uplift you. The first step is familiarizing yourself with the ananda culture, and assisting your team. Remember, everyone here that may inspire you, started exactly where you are. We are a team and you are an important part of it.

Objective

To kick start your career as a professional hairstylist through elevated education and guidance to grow your eye, hand and heart. We aim to shape your skills and professional aptitude by assessing your current strengths and weaknesses so that we can help you achieve your individual path to success.

Description

Our apprentice program is your pathway to be a commission stylist through education and training which will give you the technical, professional and personal skills for success. Apprentices will assist and observe ananda stylist/mentors and coordinators while maintaining the cleanliness and organization of the salon space. You will have group classes to attend as well as model days to practice your skills. The timeline to becoming a stylist is in your hands. You will progress at your own speed. You will become a commission stylist when you and the mentor team feels you are ready. When not assisting a stylist one on one, the apprentice duties are to help keep the salon clean and tidy. The job of maintaining your surroundings will continue well after you become a stylist.

Types of shifts

1. Salon Assistant Shift (level 1)

Your focus is supporting the salon. Cleaning, laundry, restocking, and helping wherever needed. Coordinators are your main point of direction, but anyone on the team may ask for help. Salon assisting requires constant movement and awareness. If you see something out of place, pick it up. If something needs to be cleaned, reset, or restocked, take care of it without being asked. The expectation is that you stay busy and engaged with tasks that benefit the salon for the duration of your shift. If you are

having trouble staying busy check with the coordinators/stylists for tasks, or reference the Salon upkeep projects list that is in the color bar.

2. Shadow Shift (level 2)

You are assigned to a stylist mentor. Your priority is observing, assisting, and supporting their clients for the duration of the shift. If a coordinator needs you, they will check in with your stylist mentor first. If your mentor is not available, a client does not wish to be observed or you are otherwise not shadowing on a shadow shift, your responsibilities return to that of a salon assistant shift.

3. Model Day Shift (level 3)

You are taking clients as an apprentice. When you are booked, your focus is your guest. When you are not booked, your responsibilities return to those of a salon assistant, and you report directly to the coordinators.

Apprentice binder

apprentices will be given a binder which will contain all the information about the apprentice program.

This binder will contain your Levels checklists, education module, head sheets, and an array of other useful info and checklists.

The binder should be with you at every class and meeting.

Your Levels checklists will be used when you have your model days/one on ones and is filled out by you and your mentor.

Meetings

You will have regular check-ins with the education director to go over your progress. Bring your apprentice binder with you.

There will also be quarterly salon meetings the first Friday of the month at 9am.

Classes

Core education takes place the first two Mondays of each month.

Advanced education takes place on Sundays once a quarter, sometimes more often.

Attendance/Tardiness/No Show

Attendance is mandatory. We expect you to be at every class and every meeting. Anything that you miss sets you back in your program.

If there is a need for you to be absent, check with management to get it approved.

Break times based on length of shift

5 hours or less - apprentices are expected to show up, having eaten and ready to work through the entire shift without a break.

Between 5 and 8 hours - apprentices are expected to take only one 15-20 minute break.

8 hour shift - apprentices are allotted a 30 minute break to eat a meal if necessary or two 15 minute breaks throughout the shift.

longer than 8 hours - apprentices can take a 30 minute break and one 15 minute break, or three 15 minute breaks.

When you go on break it is your responsibility to communicate with the coordinators before you take a break.

We expect that you come to the salon ready to work and stay busy for the duration of your shift. There are always productive things to do in the salon!

Salon Etiquette

- We expect you to have a cheerful readiness and alacrity to learn and to take direction. To be alert, helpful, and enthusiastic about helping all ananda team members and clients. Smile! Everyone can see you and feel your energy.
- Apprentices are required to dress in all shades of black, and wear body appropriate clothing. You may wear color accessories (scarves, jewelry, shoes, socks). No scrubs please!
- You must arrive for your shift 15 minutes early (exception for apprentices still in school)
- All makeup and hair styling is to be done at home, not at the salon. Individualism is encouraged, but keep it clean, trendy and professional. Clean clothes and shoes. If you can't decide if you look ok, then you should change into something you know looks awesome.
- Keep Body odor neutral. No loud perfumes, smoke, or natural body odor. We are close to all kinds of people with different sensitivities.
- Please keep cell phone use to a minimum. You may check your phone during your break time. You may have your phone on model days for showing hair

photos to clients as well as taking photos. Don't walk around scrolling or viewing your phone.

- Put your belongings away before you clock in. Clock out when your shift is over unless otherwise needed. Clock in for meetings as well as education. Please have management adjust your times if you forget to clock in/out.
- Do not have lengthy group conversations on the floor. When on the floor, you are representing ananda. Be mindful and respectful of other stylists and clients. Do not interrupt stylists when they are with their clients unless it is important. Always say "excuse me" to the client AND stylist if you need to speak with them.
- Apprentices should be on the salon floor as much as possible. **If you are in the kitchen or color bar with another apprentice, one of you should go up to the salon floor.**
- Keep language positive and neutral. When complimenting a client, use phrases like "Your hair looks great" or "that style looks amazing" or "how fun!" Do NOT use descriptive words like "angled bob, stacked, layers, choppy, warm, red, ash, cool, green, blue, copper, mocha latte, caramel sprinkles, etc." Don't want to give the wrong influence of what their hair looks like.
- Never badmouth another salon, a fellow employee, or a client. Ever! Don't ask where a client went for their terrible haircut or color. It's not our business, and they are at our salon now. That is all that matters.
- Do not overcrowd the front desk or stand with your back to the front door. Be ready to greet clients walking in the door.
- Do not stand with arms across your chest. It comes across as uninviting. When you make eye contact with a guest, smile.
- Greet clients using their name (check the appointment book) when on the floor
- Please eat before your shift if needed. You should come in ready to work. Do not take multiple snack breaks as an excuse to sit down and be on your phone. Snack when needed. Lunches should be coordinated between apprentices, so not more than one person is eating lunch at the same time.
- Apprentices are not permitted to do one another's hair (shampoos, blowouts, or any other services) during a shift unless specifically directed to do so by a mentor. If the salon, is slow, all projects are caught up and there are three or more apprentices available to assist the salon, apprentices may check in with coordinators or mentors to see if they can practice services on one another, in the case that it is permitted services should be completed as swiftly and promptly as possible, the apprentice receiving the service must clock out for the duration of the service.

Opening

If you are working a salon assistant shift that takes place at the beginning of salon hours you are responsible for starting laundry, setting up the color bar, filling towel warmers, and making sure the salon is presentable to start the day.

Closing

If you are working a salon assistant shift that takes place at the end of salon hours, you are responsible for the apprentice closing checklist. In order to clock-out, you and your coworkers must complete all tasks on the closing check list and have the checklist approved, signed and dated by a coordinator before leaving.

Shadowing Stylists and Working with a Mentor

Mentors play an important role in your successful completion of the apprentice program as well as your pathway to being a professional stylist. They will give you an opportunity to work alongside them to observe the communication skills and industry techniques needed to give the client the experience they are looking for.

- Go over everything with your stylist/mentor BEFORE you shadow. Ask for their feedback on how they would like you to shadow.
- Keep a comfortable distance from clients and stylists/mentors. The client may feel uncomfortable if you are too close.
- Let the stylist introduce you to their client. Do not ask questions or speak to stylists unless they address you.
- Do not stand in front or directly next to the client while they are being shampooed or during a service.
- Ask questions AFTER the service if you did not understand something the stylist did.
- Remember to not make their service harder/longer, help them be proficient while you are learning.
- Always communicate with your mentor before taking breaks or leaving for the day.
- If another stylist or mentor asks for your assistance, let them know that you are willing to help but you need to check with your assigned mentor first.

Shampoo Techniques and the ananda Head Wrap

You should be able to do a quick shampoo and a long shampoo. Your stylist should communicate with you which they need if you are shampooing for them. A quick shampoo should not feel rushed.

Your head wraps should be tight, but not too tight. A tight head wrap allows the client to move their head without the wrap coming undone. Make sure you do not pull the client's hair when tucking in the corners.

Always drape the client before the shampoo. This helps with keeping them dry.

Blowouts, Products, and Hot Tool Styling

You are required to have ananda approved professional tools. Blowdryer, combs, various brushes, clips, scissors, etc. Everything needed to perform the tasks asked of you.

We can help you purchase your tools by taking a percentage out of your paycheck as a “payment plan” if needed.

Product knowledge

Knowledge is power, and product knowledge is essential for you to be able to properly educate your clients.

You will be required to familiarize yourself with the Davines product line, and be able to explain why you're using specific products.

There is physical and electronic product knowledge information available, though we feel through listening to/watching stylists, and getting your hand in hair, you will develop the most thorough knowledge.

You are encouraged to use all the different products on yourself (at home) for trial and error. Use your discount, get product samples, and familiarize yourself with the line!

Client Recruitment & Book Building

Once apprentices begin taking models, it is an expectation that you demonstrate the ability to recruit and build your own clientele. We will support you, offer guidance, and help generate opportunities, including booking you clients, but it is your responsibility to show us that you can grow and sustain your book. This means using the skills you are developing in cleanliness, positivity, professionalism, and service execution to create an experience that clients want to return to. Building a strong clientele is not only about technical talent; it is about connection, consistency, and initiative. Developing this ability is essential to becoming a confident, successful stylist, and we expect to see steady effort and growth as you move through the program.

Ethos

When you learn to be truly aware of your surroundings, and it is second nature to keep your space and shared spaces immaculate, it makes you one step closer to being a world class stylist.

When you are able to derive joy, from serving your clients and coworkers, you are truly serving yourself.

When small actions that separate our salon from others become your habits, you will excel in this industry.

Never stop learning, let love, kindness and efficiency guide your actions.

These tools will not only allow you to thrive at ananda, but anywhere in the world.